

ALASTAIR McNEILL

YILA

SOUND ARTIST • ELECTRONIC COMPOSER • PRODUCER • PERFORMER

www.alastairmcneill.com

Profile

British sound artist, electronic composer and producer from Essex. McNeill's practice moves between record production, spatial and generative sound, installation, audio-visual performance, live musical direction, theatre composition and commercial composition. His work frequently combines voice, field recording, electronic production and movement-responsive systems across stereo, binaural, Ambisonic and large multichannel formats.

Selected collaborators and credits include Róisín Murphy, Chris Eckman, Scroobius Pip, Mina Špiler / Laibach, David Toop, HK119, Dani Siciliano, Matevž Kolenc, Andrej Predin, Maya Schenck, Max Sansalone and Guy Davies.

Current theatre composition work includes Blink.

Core practice

- Composition, production, recording, mixing, arranging and executive production
- Spatial audio: Ambisonics, binaural sound and multichannel speaker systems
- Sound installation, generative audio and motion-responsive performance systems
- Artistic direction, show design, pre-production and live musical direction
- Performance on synthesizers, guitar, voice processing, tape and electronics
- Original music, sonic identity, sound design, music supervision and screen mixing

Selected career highlights

- Producer of Chris Eckman's *The Land We Knew the Best*, named *Uncut's* Album of the Month and No. 26 in its 80 best albums of 2025.
- Co-producer of Eckman's *Where the Spirit Rests*, winner of a 2021 German Record Critics' Annual Award.
- Executive producer and mix engineer for Scroobius Pip's *Distraction Pieces*.
- World touring musician and show-production collaborator with Róisín Murphy.
- Member of David Toop's *Unknown Devices* improvisers orchestra, performing at Tate Modern, Tate Britain, the Barbican Centre and South London Gallery.
- Creator and co-creator of spatial installations using up to 14.2-channel custom systems.

Sound art, spatial work & installations

The World as a Composer | Concept, sound & spatialisation

Digital work using Covid-era announcements and real-time movement data to reshape official language. Motion-tracking code by Hiroshi Matoba; Ambisonic and binaural sound.

Cross Intentions | Co-creator / spatial sound

Motion-triggered installation about the use of personal data to predict and influence behaviour. Generative musical material was dispersed through an eight-channel Ambisonic system, with a binaural video stream; text by Andrej Predin, programming by Sebastian Fresch and voice by Katja Preša.

Souvenir: Razkritje | Performer / system design

Two improvised Ambisonic sound events created entirely from recorded voice, based on a commissioned script by Andrej Predin. Performed with Matevž Kolenc and Mauricio Valdés at Sonica Festival and Vodnikova domačija on a custom 6.2-channel system.

Idú | Co-artistic director

Experimental audio-visual performance co-directed with Eddie Stevens at Nástupište 1-12, Slovakia, developed from Jana Kirschner's track 'Čierna'. Presented through a custom 14.2-channel speaker and performance system.

PWCA Tree | Creator / sound installation

Autonomous generative public sound installation presented for three days inside a tree at Green Man Festival, using a 12-channel Ambisonic array.

Sound of Kings | Creator / composition

Participatory sound work tracing the transformation of King's Cross, London. Publicly submitted recordings were composed into a work presented through a recycled multispeaker installation and sculpture.

Souvenir | Co-producer / performer

Multimedia musical theatre for an eight-piece band, dual large-scale projection and CRT screens. Combined music, sonic art, animation, found sound, spoken word and stories by Steven Camden; produced with Jvan Morandi and Camden.

Souvenir: Suvenir | Artistic director

Slovak multidisciplinary development of Souvenir, bringing together artists working across performance, sound, image and text into a shared group practice.

Compulse | Co-creator / sound

Audio-visual collaboration between Flyfaction and Yila, combining animation, stills and live action around selfhood, memory and loss; projected beneath London's Westway.

Playing God | Creator / sound installation

Motion-triggered and manipulated storm environment reflecting the relationship between human activity and climate change. 4.1 sound and projection.

Record production, releases & artist projects

The Only Thing I Know - Krajncan Brothers (2026) | Mastering

Mastered the complete debut album by Žigan and Kristijan Krajncan, incorporating the two tracks previously mastered by Chris Pavey into the final album master.

Zhlehtet / Rok Zalokar (2023–2026) | Mastering

Ongoing mastering collaboration at Nature Scene Studios across Poletje Loops, Portals Vol. 2, Vrt, Faded Worlds Suite, Pieces for Collective Change and Intention, Intensity, Shuffle.

The Land We Knew the Best - Chris Eckman (2025) | Producer / guitars / instrumentation

Produced Eckman's seventh solo album and contributed electric, acoustic and nylon-string guitars, percussion, electric cello and Hammond organ. Released by Glitterhouse Records; selected as Uncut's Album of the Month with a 9/10 review and ranked No. 26 in the magazine's 80 best albums of 2025.

Dysfunctional Combinations & Collaborations, Vol. 2 - Yila | Producer / mix / composition

Dance-floor project built through collaborations with Maya Schenck, Max Sansalone and Christian Kroupa, alongside a purpose-recorded five-piece jazz ensemble. Recorded and mixed at Nature Scene Studios; mastered by Guy Davies at Electrical Audio.

Where the Spirit Rests - Chris Eckman | Co-producer / recording / mix

Co-produced Eckman's fifth solo album, framing the songwriting with treated strings, analogue synth drones and ambient guitars. Released on Glitterhouse Records in stereo on 12-inch LP and digital formats; winner of a 2021 Annual Award from the German Record Critics' Award (Preis der deutschen Schallplattenkritik).

Functional Combinations & Collaborations, Vol. 1 - Yila | Artist / producer / mix

Collaborative dance release with Giom and Christian Kroupa / Alleged Witches, combining club production, spatialisation techniques and each artist's distinct musical language. Released on 12-inch vinyl through Juno and digitally.

Crest / Kreda | Writer / producer / mix

Anglo-Slovene experimental pop collaboration with Mina Špiler, Matevž Kolenc and Atej Tutta. Music was composed to visual material and developed through stereo, Ambisonic and binaural approaches.

Better (of) Me - Yila featuring Mina Špiler | Writer / producer / mix

Digital EP with remixes by Dave DK, Rose Tinted & Anna Be, and Christian Kroupa / Alleged Witches. Mastered by Mandy Parnell.

Overload - Yila | Artist / producer

EP released on Silver Bear, Rob da Bank's Sunday Best techno imprint, with remixes by Kasra V and Nummer. Stereo digital release with video.

Distraction Pieces - Scroobius Pip | Executive producer / producer / mix engineer

Executive-produced and mixed the solo album released by Speech Development in the UK and Strange Famous Records in North America; also contributed guitars, synths and backing vocals.

Angles - Dan Le Sac vs Scroobius Pip | Production / mix

Production and mixing for the commercially successful album that launched the duo and included the single 'Thou Shalt Always Kill'.

Oh No, the Drift of the World - Jackamo Brown | Recording / mix

Recorded live in a Hackney church and mixed for CD and digital release, incorporating additional field recordings by Jackamo Brown.

Un puit qui fuit - Garance and the Mitochondries | Producer

Produced the full-length album, mixed by Dilip Harris and mastered by Mandy Parnell, for CD and digital release.

Record production, releases & artist projects (continued)**Ceramic - Aloosh | Artist / production**

Debut eight-track experimental indie-pop album released on Nature Scene Records as a limited heavyweight 12-inch, accompanied by a two-part film directed by J G Harding.

Astronaut - Yila featuring Scroobius Pip | Artist / producer

Release featuring remixes by Clark (Warp) and Dan Le Sac, issued with video on seven-inch vinyl and digital formats.

Takin' Off - Palmer | Songwriter / arranger / remixer / mix

Songwriting, arrangement, remix and mix for the French band's debut nu-disco release.

Matevž Kolenc | Mix / pre-master / spatialisation

Mixing, pre-mastering and spatialisation for Kolenc's work across stereo and binaural formats.

Skate Uphill | Co-writer / performer

Commissioned song for a Werewolf Films video promoting Nokia PureView; written with Leander Lyons, with guitar and vocal performance.

Live performance, direction & broadcast**SO.UND.ING Acousmonium INput - Kino Šiška (2026) | Participating sound artist / live spatial performance**

Presented original work within Cona and Kino Šiška's two-day festival of live spatial sound events in the Komuna Hall, transformed into an octophonic listening environment. The programme brought together international electroacoustic artists for live interpretation and performance.

Ropotarnica XXIX - Galerija ŠKUC (2023) | Solo performer / spatial sound

Solo concert centred on the SOMA Dvina, a cello-like electronic instrument, combined with live electronics and real-time sound processing in Galerija ŠKUC's multichannel spatial setup. The performance explored the instrument's textures through improvisation and spatial placement.

Hairless Toys - Róisín Murphy world tour | Show design / pre-production / musician

Show design and pre-production, including implementation of audio-reactive visuals with Jvan Morandi; performed synthesizers, vocal effects processing and guitar.

Overpowered - Róisín Murphy world tour | Guitar

Touring guitarist for Róisín Murphy's Overpowered world tour.

Imaginature - HK119 | Musical director / performer

Musical director for the European tour supporting the One Little Indian album; performed synthesizers, backing vocals and ukulele.

Dani Siciliano | Musical director

Musical director for the live presentation of Dani Siciliano's self-titled album on Circus Company.

Unknown Devices - David Toop | Ensemble member / performer

Member of Toop's improvisers orchestra, with performances at Tate Modern, Tate Britain, Kubrick Festival, the Barbican Centre and South London Gallery.

Nature Scene Sessions | Producer / curator / broadcast

Series of livestreamed performances from Nature Scene Studio, filmed with multiple retro cameras and transmitted in stereo and binaural sound.

Live performance, direction & broadcast (continued)**Reel to Reel Night Programme - Radio Študent | Live performer**

Improvised broadcast performance with Luka Seliškar and Jure Anžiček using three tape machines, modular synthesizers and a radio-broadcast loop.

Izis 6 | Live performer

Real-time improvised manipulation of Karlo Hmeljak's voice and poetry with Matevž Kolenc, accompanied by a reactive lighting system by Mitja Cerkevnik.

Brez Upora - Radio Študent / Radart | Live performer

Thirty-minute live radio improvisation manipulating Ana Predin's reading of Andrej Predin's story through digital and tape techniques; streamed in stereo.

SEQ - Polyend | Live performer

Live improvised promotional performance for the Polyend SEQ with Miha Šajina / Shekuza, Tine Grgurevič / Bowrain and Matevž Kolenc, streamed via web cameras.

Commercial composition, sound design & screen**Tiha milost / V poltemi (2026) | Mix / arranger**

Mix and arrangement for the film.

Behind the Cover: Rouge Dior - Harper's Bazaar | Composition / sound design

Original composition and sound design for a film about Bazaar's bespoke Dior cover and collaboration with artist Aurore de la Morinerie. Produced by London Sessions and directed by Stephanie Pochet; cello by Lucy Railton.

Jean Imbert / Sojasun | Composition / recording / mix

Created a sonic identity for a nationwide advertising campaign, used for more than five years across television, web and radio.

Felicity | Composer / music supervisor / sound designer / mixer

Original score, music supervision, sound design and final mix for the short film, delivered in 5.1 Dolby Surround.

Let's Aurora | Composer

Web composition for an Oxford Big Project award-winning video; stereo delivery.

Technical formats & contexts

- Stereo production for vinyl, CD, digital, television, web and radio
- Binaural and Ambisonic composition, mixing, streaming and installation
- Custom 4.1, 6.2, eight-channel, 12-channel and 14.2-channel systems
- Live broadcast, audiovisual performance, projection and motion-triggered sound
- Studio recording, location recording, field recording and tape-based performance

Selected venues, platforms & organisations

Tate Modern; Tate Britain; Barbican Centre; South London Gallery; Green Man Festival; Sonica Festival; Vodnikova domačija; Nástupište 1-12; Radio Študent; Nature Scene Studio; Glitterhouse Records; Speech Development Records; Strange Famous Records; Silver Bear / Sunday Best; One Little Indian; Juno; Polyend; Harper's Bazaar; Nokia; Sojasun.